

Word family: **stubborn / stubbornly / stubbornness**

Base word: stubborn

Part of speech: adjective

Related forms:

stubbornly (adv.) — 固執地；頑固地

stubbornness (n.) — 固執；頑固

Useful expressions / extensions:

stubborn person

stubborn child

stubborn refusal

stubborn resistance

stubborn determination

stubborn problem

stubborn stain

stubborn illness / infection

stubbornly refuse

stubbornly resist

Meaning in this passage

> Of course, no child is perfect, and he can be a bit **stubborn** once in a while.

Here, **stubborn** means:

unwilling to change your mind, behaviour, or decision even when other people try to persuade you — 固執的；倔強的；不肯讓步的

The speaker is saying that Leo sometimes insists on doing things his own way or refuses to change his mind.

中文翻譯：

當然，沒有小孩是完美的，而他偶爾也會有點**固執 / 倔強**。

So here:

stubborn = 有時堅持自己的想法，不太願意聽別人勸或改變決定

1. **stubborn** (人：固執的) — 固執的；倔強的；頑固的

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> He can be a bit **stubborn** once in a while.

他偶爾也會有點**固執 / 倔強**。

Practice 2

> She is too **stubborn** to admit that she was wrong.

她太**固執**，不肯承認自己錯了。

Practice 3

> He's a **stubborn** child who always wants to do things his own way.

他是個很**倔強**的孩子，總想按自己的方式做事。

MCQ-ready definition:

stubborn = 即使別人勸說、提供理由或指出問題，仍不願改變自己的想法、決定或行為

2. **stubborn about something** — 對某事固執

Practice 1

> He is very **stubborn about his opinions**.

他對自己的意見非常**固執**。

Practice 2

> She can be **stubborn about small things**.

她有時會對一些小事很**執着、不肯讓步**。

MCQ-ready definition:

stubborn about something = 在某件事情上堅持自己的立場，不願改變

3. **stubborn refusal** — 固執地拒絕；堅決不肯

Practice 1

> His **stubborn refusal** to apologize made the situation worse.

他**固執地拒絕道歉**，令情況更糟。

Practice 2

> Her **stubborn refusal** to ask for help caused unnecessary problems.

她**堅持不肯求助**，造成了不必要的問題。

MCQ-ready definition:

stubborn refusal = 即使有充分理由改變決定，仍堅持拒絕某事

4. **stubborn resistance** — 頑強抵抗；堅持抗拒

Practice 1

> The proposal met with **stubborn resistance**.

這項提議遭到**頑強反對**。

Practice 2

> The group maintained **stubborn resistance** to the change.

該團體一直**強硬抗拒**這項改變。

MCQ-ready definition:

stubborn resistance = 長時間堅持反對或抗拒，不容易被說服或改變

5. **stubborn determination** — 頑強的決心；堅韌的堅持

This is a more positive extension.

Practice 1

> Her **stubborn determination** helped her finish the race.

她那股**頑強的決心**幫助她完成比賽。

Practice 2

> He succeeded through **stubborn determination**.

他憑着**不屈不撓的決心**取得成功。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****stubborn determination = 即使遇到困難也不肯放棄的強烈決心****

6. **stubborn problem — 難以解決的問題**

Here, **stubborn** no longer describes a person's personality.

Practice 1

> We are still trying to solve a **stubborn problem** with the system.

我們仍在設法解決系統上一個**很難處理的問題**。

Practice 2

> Inflation remains a **stubborn problem**.

通脹仍然是一個**難以解決的問題**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****stubborn problem = 持續存在、即使用了很多方法仍難以解決的問題****

7. **stubborn stain — 頑固污漬**

A very common non-human sense.

Practice 1

> This cleaner removes **stubborn stains**.

這種清潔劑可以去除**頑固污漬**。

Practice 2

> The red wine left a **stubborn stain** on the carpet.

紅酒在地毯上留下了一個**很難清除的污漬**。

MCQ-ready definition:

stubborn stain = 很難洗掉或清除的污漬

8. **stubborn dirt / grease — 頑固污垢 / 油漬**

Practice 1

> The brush is designed to remove **stubborn dirt**.

這把刷子是用來清除**頑固污垢**的。

Practice 2

> Hot water can help loosen **stubborn grease**.

熱水可以幫助溶解**難清除的油漬**。

MCQ-ready definition:

stubborn dirt/grease = 緊黏在表面、不容易清除的污垢或油脂

9. **stubborn illness / infection — 頑固、久治不癒的疾病 / 感染**

Practice 1

> He has been suffering from a **stubborn cough** for weeks.

他已經咳了幾個星期，這個咳嗽非常**頑固、一直不好**。

Practice 2

> The doctor treated a **stubborn infection**.

醫生治療了一種**久治不癒的感染**。

MCQ-ready definition:

stubborn illness/infection = 持續很久、不容易消失或治癒的疾病或感染

10. **stubborn pain / symptom — 持續不退的痛楚 / 症狀**

Practice 1

> She has a **stubborn pain** in her shoulder.

她肩膀有一種**持續不退的痛楚**。

Practice 2

> The symptom proved surprisingly **stubborn**.

這個症狀出奇地**難以消退**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****stubborn pain/symptom = 持續存在、難以消除的痛楚或症狀****

11. **stubbornly refuse — 固執地拒絕**

Practice 1

> He **stubbornly refused** to change his mind.

他**固執地拒絕**改變主意。

Practice 2

> She **stubbornly refused** to accept any help.

她**堅持不肯**接受任何幫助。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****stubbornly refuse = 以非常固執、不肯讓步的方式拒絕某事****

12. **stubbornly insist — 固執地堅持**

Practice 1

> He **stubbornly insisted** that he was right.

他**固執地堅持**自己是對的。

Practice 2

> She **stubbornly insisted on doing everything herself**.

她**固執地堅持**所有事情都要自己做。

MCQ-ready definition:

stubbornly insist = 不願接受其他意見，堅持自己的立場或做法

13. **stubbornly resist — 頑強抗拒**

Practice 1

> The material **stubbornly resisted** attempts to bend it.

這種材料**很難被彎曲**。

Practice 2

> He **stubbornly resisted** every suggestion.

他對每個建議都**固執地抗拒**。

MCQ-ready definition:

stubbornly resist = 持續而強烈地抗拒改變、壓力或影響

14. **stubbornness — 固執；頑固**

Practice 1

> His **stubbornness** sometimes causes arguments.

他的**固執**有時會引起爭執。

Practice 2

> Her **stubbornness** made it difficult to reach an agreement.

她的**頑固**令大家很難達成協議。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****stubbornness = 不願改變主意或讓步的性格特質****

15. ****stubbornness (正面：堅韌) — 不肯放棄的堅持****

Depending on context, ****stubbornness**** can sometimes be viewed positively.

Practice 1

> A certain amount of ****stubbornness**** helped him keep going.

某程度的****堅持 / 倔強****幫助他繼續下去。

Practice 2

> Her ****stubbornness**** became a strength when things got difficult.

情況變得困難時，她那份****不肯放棄的倔強****反而成為優點。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****stubbornness = 堅持到底、不輕易放棄的特質；語境不同時可帶正面或負面色彩****

Important distinction 1: ****stubborn vs determined****

This is one of the most important contrasts.

****determined****

usually positive:

= strongly decided to achieve something.

> She is ****determined**** to succeed.

她下定決心要成功。

****stubborn****

often negative:

= refuses to change despite reasons to do so.

> She is too ****stubborn**** to listen.

她太固執，不肯聽別人的話。

So:

* **determined** → 有決心

* **stubborn** → 固執、不肯改變

But context can make stubbornness sound admiring if persistence is useful.

Important distinction 2: **stubborn vs persistent**

persistent

keeps trying or continues for a long time.

stubborn

adds the idea of **resistance to change**.

> a **persistent student**

不斷努力的學生

> a **stubborn student**

不肯改變想法的學生

So persistence can be positive without stubbornness.

Important distinction 3: **stubborn vs strong-willed**

strong-willed

usually means having a powerful independent will.

stubborn

means unwilling to change or compromise.

A strong-willed person can be flexible; a stubborn person usually isn't.

For a child:

> **strong-willed** can sound more positive than **stubborn**.

Important distinction 4: **stubborn** vs **obstinate**

Very close.

stubborn

ordinary everyday word.

obstinate

more formal and often stronger/more negative.

> an **obstinate refusal**

頑固地拒絕

For normal conversation, **stubborn** is much more common.

Important distinction 5: **stubborn** vs **inflexible**

stubborn

usually describes a person, attitude, resistance, or persistent problem.

inflexible

means unable or unwilling to change, especially:

- * rules

- * systems

- * schedules

- * attitudes

> an **inflexible policy**

缺乏彈性的政策

> a **stubborn person**

固執的人

Important distinction 6: **stubborn vs difficult**

A **difficult problem** may simply be complicated.

A **stubborn problem** specifically keeps resisting attempts to solve it.

So:

> difficult problem = 難題

> stubborn problem = **一直解決不了的難題**

The persistence is important.

Important distinction 7: **stubborn stain vs dirty stain**

A **stubborn stain** does not mean particularly dirty.

It means:

difficult to remove

So the key semantic extension is:

person refuses to move/change

→ **stain refuses, metaphorically, to disappear**

Important distinction 8: **stubborn illness vs serious illness**

These are not the same.

serious illness

dangerous or severe.

stubborn illness

persistent and difficult to treat.

An illness can be stubborn without being life-threatening.

Important distinction 9: **stubborn vs rebellious**

stubborn

doesn't change mind.

rebellious

actively resists authority, rules, or control.

A stubborn child may simply insist on wearing one particular shirt.

A rebellious child deliberately challenges authority.

Important distinction 10: **stubborn vs selfish**

These are different personality traits.

stubborn

unwilling to change.

selfish

puts own interests before others.

A person can be stubborn but generous — which is exactly possible in your Leo passage.

Important distinction 11: **stubborn vs opinionated**

opinionated

has very strong opinions and expresses them confidently, often excessively.

stubborn

refuses to change those opinions or decisions.

Someone can be opinionated but willing to change their mind after hearing evidence.

Important distinction 12: **a bit stubborn**

In your passage:

> he can be **a bit stubborn**

The phrase **a bit** softens the criticism.

It means:

有一點固執

rather than:

非常頑固

That fits the warm tone of the paragraph: the speaker acknowledges an imperfection without presenting it as a serious character flaw.

Important distinction 13: **stubborn person vs stubborn thing**

This is a productive metaphorical extension.

Person

> a **stubborn child**

不肯改變主意的孩子

Thing/problem

> a **stubborn stain**

怎樣也很難清掉的污漬

The shared concept is:

resists attempts to make it change

Family-extension note

****Stubborn**** has two major modern semantic branches built around a very clear core idea:

****resisting change****

1. ****people / attitudes****

- * stubborn person
- * stubborn refusal
- * stubborn resistance

2. ****problems / physical conditions****

- * stubborn stain
- * stubborn cough
- * stubborn problem
- * stubborn infection

The metaphor is straightforward:

****a stubborn person refuses to change****

→ ****a stubborn problem or stain seems to “refuse” to go away****

There is also an important evaluative spectrum:

- * ****negative:**** obstinate, unreasonable, inflexible
- * ****more positive:**** persistent, determined, unwilling to give up

So context matters a lot.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
-----	-----	-----	
stubborn person	固執的；倔強的	unwilling to change	
stubborn child	倔強的孩子	insists on own way	
stubborn about X	對 X 固執	fixed position	
stubborn refusal	固執地拒絕	refuses to yield	
stubborn resistance	頑強抵抗	resists change/pressure	
stubborn determination	頑強決心	refuses to give up	
stubborn problem	頑固難題	difficult to solve	

stubborn stain	頑固污漬	difficult to remove	
stubborn dirt	頑固污垢	difficult to clean	
stubborn cough	久咳不癒	persistent symptom	
stubborn infection	頑固感染	difficult to treat	
stubborn pain	持續不退的痛楚	persistent pain	
stubbornly refuse	固執地拒絕	refuse firmly	
stubbornly insist	固執地堅持	insist without yielding	
stubbornly resist	頑強抗拒	continue resisting	
stubbornness	固執；頑固	quality of stubbornness	
stubbornness (positive shade)	堅韌；不肯放棄	persistent will	

For your original sentence

> Of course, no child is perfect, and he can be **a bit stubborn once in a while**.

Here:

stubborn = 固執的；倔強的；偶爾不肯改變自己的想法

And **a bit** is important:

> **a bit stubborn** = **有點固執**

while:

> **very stubborn** = **非常頑固**

The speaker is gently acknowledging a small flaw in Leo's personality, not criticizing him harshly.

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 當然，沒有小孩是完美的，而他**偶爾也會有點固執**。

So the exact passage sense is the straightforward **personality sense: unwilling to change one's mind or give way easily**.